

[PAGE 46]

COVER STORY

I AM NO LONGER AFRAID OF SUCCESS

THE ROLES THAT MADE HER DISCOVER HER STRENGTH. THE NEED SHE HAD TO CONTROL EVERYTHING AND THE MAN WITH WHOM SHE REALIZED IT IS BEAUTIFUL TO LET GO.

BENEDETTA PORCAROLI HAS GROWN UP AND IS READY FOR NEW CHALLENGES, INCLUDING A CONCRETE COMMITMENT TO WOMEN. AND TO HER PEERS, SHE SAYS: "LET'S GO AND TAKE THE SPACE WE DESERVE."

Text by Marina Speich

[PAGE 56]

Benedetta Porcaroli arrives at our fashion shoot with her mother, Marianna Barracane. «Every now and then she comes with me, especially to the premieres of my films. She loves accompanying me to the Venice Film Festival. And, between the two of us, she is often the most anxious one,» says the actress, laughing. «We are very close. Parents, after all, are our punching bags: my mom is used to hearing all my outbursts. Let's tell the truth: I like being big, an adult, but I know I can always go back and be the daughter if I need to.» When I interview Benedetta, she has already returned to Rome: she lives in a wonderful apartment in a historic building. In her living room, there are paintings and a large mirror leaning against the walls: «I like them like that. And I love the idea of a house full of objects, memories that make me feel good. There are candles, postcards, books, little notes that I don't want to lose and perhaps place between a stone, a shell, or a plant.» In a few months, we will see her on Netflix in the second season of the series *The Gentlemen*, the gangster movie created by Guy Ritchie. And after the summer, the film *7 anniversari* will be released, directed by Sabrina Iannucci, in which she is the protagonist: it tells the story of a couple who stipulates a "pact" to love each other without fear for only seven years. In recent weeks, she has dedicated herself to a project on female empowerment, *Pomellato for Women*, alongside other celebrities like actress Jane Fonda.

WHAT DOES IT MEAN TO PARTICIPATE IN THIS CAMPAIGN AGAINST GENDER VIOLENCE? «My generation often takes many battles for female emancipation for granted. But when you see the Istat data on female unemployment—extremely high compared to male unemployment—you realize that the responsibility of twenty-year-olds is to expand the female space conquered by previous generations. We, too, are daughters of a male-dominated cultural legacy:

sometimes we are afraid to take up space and the success we deserve, just because we fear that men might feel bad about it.»

ACCORDING TO RESEARCH CONDUCTED BY THE CELEBRATED JEWELRY BRAND IN COLLABORATION WITH SDA BOCCONI, SEVEN OUT OF TEN ITALIAN WOMEN HAVE SUFFERED SOME FORM OF ECONOMIC VIOLENCE. «It is an invisible and very widespread form of violence: I closely know women who have worked their whole lives and still ask their husbands for permission if they need to buy something because they have a shared account. Economic control is subtle, but in fact, it prevents women from being free.»

TODAY, ACTORS AND PUBLIC FIGURES USE THEIR VISIBILITY TO SUPPORT SOCIAL, POLITICAL, OR ENVIRONMENTAL CAUSES.

[PAGE 58]

«Fortunately, in the United States, there are committed stars: Bad Bunny's performance at the Super Bowl Halftime Show transformed the stage into a political act of inclusion. I reflect a lot on activism in the world of entertainment: on one hand, if you expose yourself, you risk being instrumentalized. But the alternative—that is, expressing no thought—is too far from how I am made. Those who never expose themselves, just so they don't lose consensus, frighten me.»

AT ONLY 27 YEARS OLD, YOU HAVE ALREADY FILMED 16 MOVIES AND MANY TV SERIES. WHICH TITLES HAVE MARKED YOUR PERSONAL EVOLUTION? «Those that allowed me to tell the condition of women, such as *L'ombra del giorno* by Giuseppe Piccioni, set on the eve of World War II, where I play Anna, threatened by the racial laws of fascism. Or *La scuola cattolica*, where I am one of the victims of the tragic Circeo massacre of 1975, which marked a turning point on the theme of sexual violence. And then the series *Il Gattopardo*, the story of a girl looking for a fracture to emancipate herself and be able to decide her own destiny: a revolutionary character.»

ORNELLA VANONI, WHOM YOU MET ON THE SET OF 7 DONNE E UN MISTERO, HAD EXPOSED HERSELF GREATLY REGARDING FEMALE EMANCIPATION. YOU WERE FRIENDS. WHAT MEMORIES DO YOU HAVE OF HER? «She taught me so much about love. For a year, as soon as we finished filming, she wrote to me or called me every day: "How is love going?", she would ask me. She was a woman who believed very much in this feeling.»

ARE YOU A WOMAN WHO KNOWS HOW TO LOVE? «I think so, at least I give it my all. Then there is a side of love that scares me: the loss of control. I struggle to let myself go.»

ARE YOU A CONTROL FREAK? «I don't love it, but it's part of me. Sometimes it saves you because it prevents you, for example, from coming home completely drunk. But then life teaches you that things happen when you least expect them. And you discover that the anxiety of control is just a waste of time.»

WHAT MADE YOU FALL IN LOVE WITH ACTOR RICCARDO SCAMARCIO FIVE YEARS AGO? «His great tenacity: he is a person who fights, and I love people who don't give up.»

DID HE ALSO FIGHT TO WIN YOU OVER? «In a certain sense, yes, he fights for me or together with me. He is a man with whom I would go into the trenches.»

DO YOU STILL HAVE A FEAR OF SLEEPING ALONE? WHEN DOES IT HAPPEN TO YOU? «Yes: to overcome it, I beg one of my friends to sleep over, but they start making up excuses not to come. And so, I fall asleep alone, but during the night I wake up with the anxiety that someone has entered the house to hurt me.»

WHO ARE YOUR FRIENDS? «Four or five that I've carried with me since childhood. More than friendships, they are almost marriages (she laughs). My best friend is Virginia, in my class from first grade to high school. She is my conscience.»

YOUR BROTHER GUGLIELMO, SEVEN YEARS YOUNGER, SAYS THAT YOU ARE A SISTER WITHOUT FILTERS. WHAT DOES THAT MEAN? «We have a relationship of total love, but I am very direct with him: if I have to say something, I say it. And every now and then he perhaps suffers from my judgment, but he has a lot of trust in me.»

WHEN YOU GET ANGRY, DO YOU STAY CALM? «No: I am explosive. I have a lot of energy, but after a few minutes, it's all over for me and I don't hold a grudge. It's hard for me to pout. But in arguments, I fire up, I get passionate: it's only through the explosion that I understand what I need.»

AND IS YOUR CENTER OF GRAVITY LOVE OR YOUR PROFESSION? «I'm looking for it within myself: because I'm quite hopeless at taking care of myself, while I'm very good at doing it for others. I don't know how to connect with my needs and, if I have to eat alone, for example, I think I can survive by snacking on something here and there, instead of preparing myself a nice plate of pasta.»